



MyGurukul

SACRED WISDOM — SATURDAY, FEBRUARY 14, 2026



SACRED TEXT

*so 'haṃ bhavadbhirdharmeṇa pareṇa ca samādhinā |
janitastapasā yukto bhavatāmeva sarvaśaḥ |
devamārādhyā narakātpitṛṃstāritavānpunaḥ || 15 ||
eṣa prabhāvo yuṣmākaṃ tapaḥ sucaritaṃ ca ha |
mamātra kiṃ mahāprajñā anṛtaṃ vātra kiṃ vacaḥ || 16 ||
iyaṃ ca vaidikī śubhrā śrutirvedavidāṃ varāḥ |
pramāṇaṃ yadi manyadhvamātmanā kṛtamityuta || 17 ||*

— Skandapurāṇa, Chapter 36, Verses 15-17

GURU'S INTERPRETATION

He acknowledges that his own liberation from the lower realms, from suffering, was directly a result of their dharma, their deep meditation, and their devoted penance. He states unequivocally that he was "born" into a higher state of being through their efforts. The phrase "devamārādhyā narakātpitṛṃstāritavānpunaḥ" highlights the power of worshipping the Divine to liberate ancestors from hellish realms. He is freed because of their devotion.

The speaker humbly attributes his salvation entirely to the merit accumulated by his descendants. He emphasizes that his own wisdom or actions played a negligible role, highlighting the immense power of their spiritual endeavors. This is not false modesty, but a profound recognition of the interconnectedness of all beings and the ability of descendants to positively influence the fate of their ancestors. He is stating that all that they have done, has directly impacted his salvation.

The passage concludes by invoking the authority of the Vedas, the ancient scriptures, as a testament to the truth of his words. He invites them, the "best of knowers of the Vedas," to consider whether the scriptures themselves validate the notion that actions performed by individuals can indeed benefit others, particularly their ancestors. This isn't just about ritualistic offerings, but about the accumulated spiritual merit, the positive energy generated through righteous living. In modern life, this reminds you that your actions have far-reaching consequences, impacting not only your own well-being but also the lives of those who came before you and those who will come after. Your commitment to ethical living, to mindful practices, and to spiritual growth can ripple outwards, creating a positive legacy that transcends generations. It urges you to live intentionally, knowing that your choices contribute to a collective karmic pool.

REFLECTION FOR TODAY

How can you consciously cultivate practices of devotion, mindfulness, and ethical living to create a positive impact on your lineage, both past and future?